PRACTITIONER PROTOCOL

Lightening & Highlights

Times in [brackets] follow your lightener's instructions and never pass its maximum. Check your state board rules.

SCREEN

Intake cleared. No sores, infection or sunburn on the scalp. Full chemical history on file.

STRAND TEST

Required for box dye, henna, metallic dye or unknown history. Record lift and time.

PRE-CARE SENT

No shampooing or scratching the scalp for [24–48] hours before. Arrive with dry hair.

SET UP FIRST ☐ Hands washed, gloves on ☐ Cape, towels, neck strip ☐ Foils, bowls, brushes ☐ Bond builder, toner ☐ Lightener in date, lots noted ☐ Timer, eyewash, SDS

#	STEP	TIME	HOW
1	**Consult**	10–15 min	Level, history, porosity, elasticity. Agree goal, sessions and price.
2	**Consent & photos**	5 min	Consent signed, strand test result checked. Before photos in good light.
3	**Section**	10 min	Plan placement: foils, balayage panels or global. Clean, clipped sections.
4	**Mix**	5 min	Lightener, developer, bond builder by weight. On-scalp: 20 vol max.
5	**Apply**	[ ] min	Off-scalp foils up to 30–40 vol per label. Virgin global: roots last.
6	**Process**	[ ] min	Never add heat to on-scalp lightener. Keep lightener off the skin.
7	**Check lift**	every 5–10	Wipe a strand: level, evenness, elasticity. Stop at maximum time, always.
8	**Rinse**	5 min	Foils off at the bowl, cool rinse. Gentle shampoo, then bond step.
9	**Tone**	[ ] min	On towel-dried hair per label. Watch closely; porous ends grab fast.
10	**Finish & photos**	10+ min	Condition, heat protectant, style. Check tone in daylight. After photos.
11	**Aftercare & rebook**	5 min	Review aftercare. Toner refresh in [4–8] weeks; book the next lift session.

ENDPOINT AND SAFETY

- Even, clean lift to the target level for the toner
- On-scalp 20 vol maximum; no heat on scalp lightener
- Hair stretches and springs back; elasticity intact
- Never past the lightener's maximum time

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

- Lightener in the eye: flush with cool running water or eyewash for 15 minutes, then seek medical care.
- Heat, smoke or odor in a foil: likely metallic dye. Rinse at once and stop all chemicals.
- Hives, swelling or wheezing: stop and rinse out. Call 911 if breathing is affected.
- Scalp burning: stop and rinse thoroughly with cool water. Never let a client push through burning.
- Gummy or stretchy hair: stop, rinse, apply a bond treatment. No more lightener today.
- Later blisters or scabs on the scalp: refer to a physician. Document and report the reaction.

Always write an incident report and check in with the client within 24 to 48 hours.

RECORD FOR THIS SESSION

Lightener · lot	Developer · ratio	Bond builder	Process time
Start · end level	**Toner · time**	**Strand test · result**	**Next visit · initials**